Eli's Reading Practice

Level 2 (about 4.0 grade level) • Words from Vowel Sounds /ou/ & /ô/
Read each passage carefully, then answer the questions. Use the passage to find evidence for your answers.

Not a Coward

(fiction)

Jonah and his dad were on a long journey to visit Grandpa in the south. By the afternoon, the sky was getting cloudier and darker. Dad turned on the radio, and the news said a big storm was coming. They stopped at a small hotel to wait it out. Soon the wind began to howl, and rain poured down so hard it seemed to drown the parking lot. Jonah hid under a blanket because the thunder was so loud. "I'm being a coward," he whispered. "Being scared doesn't make you a coward," Dad said. "Brave people feel scared too." Dad helped him prepare a flashlight and a couple of snacks, just in case the power went out. When the lights flickered, Jonah was the one who turned on the flashlight. He held it steady while Dad found the candles. By morning, the storm had passed, and the road was clear again. Storms felt a lot more familiar to Jonah now, and he couldn't wait to tell Grandpa.

Questions

1. What is this story mostly about?

a) A family moves to a new town.
b) Jonah learns that being scared during a storm doesn't make him a coward.
c) Dad fixes a broken flashlight.
d) Grandpa visits a hotel.

2. Where were Jonah and his dad going?

a) to the beach
b) to visit Grandpa in the south
c) to a hotel by the lake
d) home from school

3. How do you think Jonah felt when he turned on the flashlight?

a) bored
b) braver and more helpful
c) angry at Dad
d) sleepy

4. "Dad helped him prepare a flashlight and a couple of snacks." What does prepare mean?

a) to get ready
b) to throw away

c) to break
d) to forget

5. Which sentence shows Dad thinks brave people can feel scared?

a) Jonah hid under a blanket because the thunder was so loud.
b) “Being scared doesn't make you a coward,” Dad said. “Brave people feel scared too.”
c) They stopped at a small hotel to wait it out.
d) By the afternoon, the sky was getting cloudier and darker.

6. What did Jonah do right after the lights flickered?

a) He hid under a blanket.
b) He turned on the flashlight.
c) He called Grandpa.
d) He went to sleep.

7. Why did Jonah and his dad stop at a hotel?

a) They were hungry.
b) Their car broke down.
c) A big storm was coming.
d) They had reached Grandpa's house.

Vocab builder: write what each word means, then use it in a sentence.

journey: _____

coward: _____

prepare: _____

couple: _____

familiar: _____

Bald Eagles Make a Comeback

(nonfiction)

The bald eagle is a large bird of prey with a white head and a brown body. Its name is a little false, because the eagle is not really bald at all. Long ago, the word bald meant "white," and that is how the bird got its name. Bald eagles build enormous nests at the top of tall trees near water. Some nests are as heavy as a small car! The eagles gather sticks, grass, and other soft material to build them. About fifty years ago, there were very few bald eagles left. A poison used on farms got into the fish that the eagles ate. The poison made the eagles' eggshells so thin that they cracked. People found a solution: the country stopped allowing farmers to use that poison. Laws also made it a crime to hurt the birds or their nests. Slowly, the number of eagles began to improve. Today, thousands of bald eagles soar over rivers and lakes across the country.

Questions

1. What is this article mostly about?

a) How to build a bird nest.
b) How bald eagles almost disappeared and then came back.
c) Why fish live in lakes.
d) How farmers grow food.

2. What do bald eagles use to build their nests?

a) mud and rocks
b) sticks, grass, and other soft material
c) only feathers
d) paper and string

3. Why do you think the laws helped the eagles?

a) The eagles could read the laws.
b) People could no longer hurt the birds or their nests.
c) The laws gave eagles more fish.
d) The laws made the trees taller.

4. "Bald eagles build enormous nests at the top of tall trees near water." What does enormous mean?

a) very small
b) very large
c) very wet
d) very old

5. Which sentence explains how the bald eagle got its name?

a) Long ago, the word bald meant “white,” and that is how the bird got its name.
b) Some nests are as heavy as a small car!
c) Slowly, the number of eagles began to improve.
d) Laws also made it a crime to hurt the birds or their nests.

6. What happened after the poison got into the fish?

a) The eagles built bigger nests.
b) The eagles' eggshells became too thin and cracked.
c) The eagles flew to other countries.
d) The eagles' heads turned white.

7. What caused the number of bald eagles to drop long ago?

a) a cold winter
b) a poison used on farms
c) too many nests
d) a lack of trees

Vocab builder: write what each word means, then use it in a sentence.

bald: _____

false: _____

enormous: _____

material: _____

solution: _____

Answer Key (for grown-ups)

Not a Coward

1. b) Jonah learns that being scared during a storm doesn't make him a coward. [Main idea]
2. b) to visit Grandpa in the south [Details]
3. b) braver and more helpful [Inference]
4. a) to get ready [Vocabulary in context]
5. b) “Being scared doesn't make you a coward,” Dad said. “Brave people feel scared too.” [Evidence]
6. b) He turned on the flashlight. [Sequence]
7. c) A big storm was coming. [Cause & effect]

Vocab: journey = a long trip from one place to another; coward = someone who is too afraid to do what they should; prepare = to get ready; couple = two, or a few; familiar = well known; something you have seen or done before

Bald Eagles Make a Comeback

1. b) How bald eagles almost disappeared and then came back. [Main idea]
2. b) sticks, grass, and other soft material [Details]
3. b) People could no longer hurt the birds or their nests. [Inference]
4. b) very large [Vocabulary in context]
5. a) Long ago, the word bald meant “white,” and that is how the bird got its name. [Evidence]
6. b) The eagles' eggshells became too thin and cracked. [Sequence]
7. b) a poison used on farms [Cause & effect]

Vocab: bald = having no hair or feathers on the head; long ago, also meant white; false = not true; enormous = very, very large; material = what something is made from; solution = an answer to a problem